



▽ Fairchild Argus 1941

Origin USA

Engine 165 hp Warner Super Scarab air-cooled 7-cylinder radial

Top speed 130 mph (209 km/h)

Based on the Model 24, which dated back to 1932, the Argus served in both US and British forces in WWII. It was used by the RAF Air Transport Auxiliary to ferry aircrew between bases and to collect aircraft.



◁ Taylorcraft Auster MkV 1942

Origin UK

Engine 130 hp Lycoming O-290-3 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 130 mph (209 km/h)

Derived from US-built Taylorcraft aircraft, and with armor plate for the pilot, the Auster V was used for light liaison and observation by the RAF in WWII. Eventually, helicopters took over this role in the 1960s.



△ Focke-Wulf Fw190 S-8 1944

Origin Germany

Engine 1,540 hp BMW 801 D-2 supercharged air-cooled 14-cylinder radial

Top speed 408 mph (657 km/h)

Around 58 examples of this successful WWII German fighter were converted or built as two-seat "Schulflugzeug" trainers late in the war to ease the transition to the more powerful fighter aircraft.



△ Fairchild C-82A Packet 1944

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 2,100 hp Pratt & Whitney R-2800-85 Double Wasp air-cooled 18-cylinder radial

Top speed 248 mph (399 km/h)

Designed during WWII as a heavy-lift cargo aircraft for carrying troops and equipment, the Packet entered service post war. It proved capacious but underpowered, resulting in a short service life.

▷ Piper L-4H Grasshopper 1944

Origin USA

Engine 65 hp Continental A-65

Top speed 85 mph (137 km/h)

US forces used this military liaison aircraft based on the Piper Cub for artillery spotting, short-range reconnaissance, and transport during WWII, alongside types from other light plane manufacturers. It proved to be a rugged workhorse.

